

PROFICIENCY IN ENGLISH - I

Comprehensive Study Notes on Historical Perspectives, IPA Phonetics (44 Phonemes) & Supra-segmentals, Spoken Discourses, Critical Reading Models, Miscue Analysis, and Lexical Word Architecture

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Curriculum Session 2026

SYLLABUS BLUEPRINT & MARKS ALLOCATION

4 Units • Total: 35 External + 15 Internal Marks

Unit 1
Status of English
History, Global Lingua Franca, NCF/NEP, L₁ vs L₂ vs FL

5 Marks

Unit 2
Oral Discourses & Phonology
IPA (44 Sounds), Stress, Rhythm, Intonation, Drama

10 Marks

Unit 3
Critical Reading Strategies
Skimming, Scanning, 4-Text Genres, Miscue Analysis

10 Marks

Unit 4
Vocabulary in Context
Open vs Closed Words, Affixes, Compounds, Idioms

10 Marks

UNIT 1: STATUS OF ENGLISH IN INDIA AND THE GLOBAL LANDSCAPE

Colonial Trajectory, Global Lingua Franca, Constitutional Mandates & The L₁/L₂/FL Continuum

WEIGHTAGE: 5 MARKS

1.1 HISTORICAL TRAJECTORY: FROM COLONIAL IMPOSITION TO NATIONAL EMPOWERMENT

Historical Evolution

The story of the English language in India is one of complex socio-political transformation. English entered India not as a neutral linguistic medium, but as an instrument of imperial governance, cultural hegemony, and bureaucratic control. Over two centuries, however, it has been Indianized and repurposed into a vital gateway for higher education, economic mobility, and national integration.

Macaulay's Minute (1835)
Lord Macaulay aimed to create "a class of persons, Indian in blood and colour, but English in taste, in opinions, in morals, and in intellect" to run the British civil bureaucracy.

Wood's Despatch (1854)
Termed the *Magna Carta of English Education in India*. Recommended English as the medium for higher learning while retaining indigenous languages for primary schooling.

Radhakrishnan Comm. (1948)
Cautioned against hasty abandonment of English in university education, famously stating: "English is a window through which we can see the scientific advancements of the world."

Kothari Comm. (1964-66)
Formalized the **Three-Language Formula** and designated English as a critical "library language" linking states and accessing global scientific literature.

1.2 & 1.3 ENGLISH AROUND US: GLOBAL LINGUA FRANCA & CURRICULUM POSITIONING

NCF 2005 & NEP 2020 Paradigm

KACHRU'S THREE CONCENTRIC CIRCLES OF ENGLISH
Linguist Braj Kachru visualizes the global spread of English into three concentric circles:

- Inner Circle** (Native, norm-providing English): UK, USA, Australia, Canada, NZ.
- Outer Circle** (India, Nigeria, Singapore): Norm-developing English used in administration, legal courts, higher education, and mass media.
- Expanding Circle** (China, Japan, Brazil): Norm-dependent English learned as a foreign language for international trade.

Today, non-native speakers of English vastly outnumber native speakers worldwide!

ENGLISH IN NCF 2005, NEP 2020 & NCF-SE 2023

- From "Elitist Gatekeeper" to "Democratic Right"**: English is no longer restricted to urban elite schools; its exposure starts from early primary years (Ka-Shreni / Class 1).
- No Disenfranchisement of Mother Tongue**: NEP 2020 mandates mother tongue / home language as the medium of instruction until at least Grade 5, with English taught communicatively.
- Aim of ELT**: To produce bilingual/multilingual learners capable of authentic communication rather than memorizing archaic grammar definitions.

English should complement, not displace, the child's rich home language!

1.4 & 1.5 CONSTITUTIONAL STATUS & THE L₁ / L₂ / FOREIGN LANGUAGE CONTINUUM

Legal & Conceptual Clarity

Under **Article 343** of the Indian Constitution, Hindi in Devanagari script is the Official Language of the Union. The Constitution originally provided that English would continue for official purposes for only 15 years (until 1965). However, due to intense socio-political concerns from non-Hindi speaking southern and northeastern states, Parliament enacted the **Official Languages Act of 1963**, formally enshrining English as the **Associate Official Language (AOL)** of India indefinitely.

KEY DIMENSION	FIRST LANGUAGE (L ₁)	SECOND LANGUAGE (L ₂)	FOREIGN LANGUAGE (FL)
Natural Acquisition vs Learning	Acquired subconsciously from birth in home and family settings.	Learned/acquired in schools and societal environments for official utility.	Learned deliberately in formal classrooms; zero daily community presence.
Societal Presence in India	Mother tongue (e.g., Assamese, Bengali, Bodo, Hindi, Karbi).	English in India (ubiquitous on signboards, banks, news, internet).	French, German, Russian, Spanish, Japanese, Mandarin.
Primary Purpose	Forming core self-concept, immediate communication, emotional bonding.	National administration, higher education, professional employment, judiciary.	Diplomatic missions, international tourism, specialized trade translation.

Crucial Takeaway for Trainees: In India, English is an **L₂ (Second Language)**, NOT a Foreign Language! Because English surrounds children on signboards, packaging, mobile screens, and textbooks, teachers must leverage this informal environmental exposure instead of treating English as an alien subject like Latin or French.

UNIT 2: ORAL DISCOURSES, LISTENING COMPREHENSION & PHONETICS

Print-Rich Environments, IPA Sound Inventory (44 Sounds), Supra-segmentals & Discourse Types

WEIGHTAGE: 10 MARKS

2.1 & 2.2 THE LANGUAGE-RICH CLASSROOM & PROCESSING LISTENING SKILLS

Receptive Foundation

Language is both a tool for human thought and our primary vehicle for socio-emotional interaction. Children cannot learn a language in sterile, silent classrooms where only the teacher speaks. To acquire English naturally, primary classrooms must be transformed into **Print-Rich and Language-Rich Environments** containing labeled classroom furniture, student drawing walls, rhyming charts, picture dictionaries, and designated reading corners.

Hearing vs. Listening with Comprehension

- Hearing**: Passive, involuntary biological perception of auditory sound waves entering the eardrum. Zero active mental focus.
- Listening**: Active, voluntary cognitive process requiring focused attention, phonological decoding, meaning extraction, and pragmatic interpretation.

Cognitive Processing in Listening

- Bottom-Up Processing**: Decoding language piece-by-piece from the acoustic data (sounds → words → phrases → sentences).
- Top-Down Processing**: Using prior background knowledge, cultural context, and situational cues to predict and infer the overall speaker meaning.

2.2.2 SEGMENTAL FEATURES: THE INTERNATIONAL PHONETIC ALPHABET (IPA)

Phonology Core: 44 Sounds

Unlike Indian languages (which are largely phonetic and transparent—we write what we speak), English exhibits an irregular, non-phonetic spelling system. The 26 Roman letters generate approximately **44 distinct phonemes (sounds)** in Received Pronunciation (RP):

12 Pure Vowels (Monophthongs) **Unchanging Quality**
Vowels produced without any glide or shift in tongue position:

- Short: /ɪ/ (sit), /e/ (bed), /ʌ/ (cat), /ʊ/ (not), /ʌ/ (cup), /ʊ/ (book), /ə/ (sofa/schwa).
- Long: /i:/ (seat), /a:/ (car), /ɔ:/ (door), /u:/ (moon), /ɜ:/ (bird).

8 Diphthongs (Vowel Glides) **Two Vowels in One**
A smooth glide from one vowel sound to another within the same syllable:

- Closing glides towards /ɪ/: /eɪ/ (day), /aɪ/ (sky), /ɔɪ/ (boy).
- Closing glides towards /ʊ/: /aʊ/ (now), /əʊ/ (go).
- Centring glides towards /a/: /ɪə/ (near), /eə/ (hair), /ʊə/ (tour).

24 Consonant Sounds **Plosives, Fricatives, etc.**
Classified by Voicing, Place, and Manner of Articulation:

- Voiceless** (Vocal cords still): /p/, /t/, /k/, /f/, /θ/ (thin), /s/, /ʃ/ (ship), /tʃ/ (church).
- Voiced** (Vocal cords vibrate): /b/, /d/, /g/, /v/, /ð/ (this), /z/, /ʒ/ (measure), /dʒ/ (judge), /m/, /n/, /l/ (sing), /r/, /w/, /j/ (yes).

Pedagogical Tool — Minimal Pairs: Pairs of words differing by only one single phoneme (e.g., *ship* /ʃɪp/ vs. *sheep* /ʃi:p/, *bat* /bæt/ vs. *bet* /bet/, *pen* /pen/ vs. *pan* /pæn/). Using minimal pair drills trains children to overcome mother-tongue phonetic interference!

2.2.3 SUPRA-SEGMENTAL FEATURES: STRESS, RHYTHM & INTONATION CONTOURS

Musical Architecture of Speech

1. Word & Sentence Stress
Giving extra breath force, higher pitch, and longer vowel duration to a syllable:

- Shift in Part of Speech**: PRE-sent (Noun/Gift) vs. pre-SENT (Verb/To offer); RE-cord (Noun) vs. re-CORD (Verb).
- Sentence Stress**: Content words (nouns, main verbs) are stressed; function words are unstressed.

2. English Rhythm (Stress-Timed)
The time interval between stressed syllables is roughly equal:

"CATS CHASE NICE"
"The CATS will have CHASED all the NICE"

Both sentences take almost identical time to utter! (Unlike Indian languages which are syllable-timed).

3. Intonation (Pitch Variation)
The rising and falling tune of the voice conveying grammatical purpose and emotion:

- Falling Tone** (↘): Definite statements, commands, Wh-questions: "Where do you live? ↘"
- Rising Tone** (↗): Polite requests, Yes/No questions: "Are you ready? ↗"
- Fall-Rise** (↘↗): Hesitation, doubt, warning: "Well, I can try... ↘↗"

2.3 – 2.5 PRODUCING ORAL DISCOURSES: CLASSROOM THEATRE & CONVERSATIONAL ROUTINES

Interactive Classroom Action

Classroom Theatre
Enacting scripted role-plays and puppet shows removes speaking inhibitions. Children adopt characters and produce authentic dialogue naturally.

Storytelling & Retelling
Teacher narrates using facial expressions and modulated vocal pitch. Children retell the narrative in their own words, building cognitive sequencing.

Situational Dialogues
Practicing telephonic conversations, railway announcements, market shopping, and reporting daily school assembly weather updates.

Fluency vs. Accuracy
Prioritize **Fluency over Accuracy** in early stages! Constant, intrusive teacher error interruption cripples a child's spontaneous desire to speak English.

UNIT 3: CRITICAL READING, COMPREHENSION & TEXTUAL DISCOURSE

Reading Mechanics, Four Discourse Genres, Three-Phase Reading Model & Kenneth Goodman's Miscue Analysis

WEIGHTAGE: 10 MARKS

3.1 STRATEGIES FOR READING: MECHANICS, MODES & SCAFFOLDING

Strategic Processing

READING MODE	OPERATIONAL DEFINITION & PRIMARY MECHANISM	EDUCATIONAL OBJECTIVE IN PRIMARY SCHOOL
Reading Aloud (সহব পাঠ)	Vocalizing written script with correct pronunciation, phrasing, stress, and pause.	Develops phonemic fluency, speech articulation, and audibility in lower primary classes.
Silent Reading (স্বীয় পাঠ)	Reading without moving lips or vocalizing; direct visual-to-mental conceptual mapping.	Maximizes reading speed, deep critical concentration, and mature cognitive comprehension.
Intensive Reading	Close, in-depth analytical study of shorter textbook passages for micro-details.	Mastering complex grammatical structures, syntax, vocabulary, and authorial style.
Extensive Reading	Rapid reading of longer texts (children's storybooks, comic magazines) for global pleasure.	Building reading habit, automatic word recognition, and broad general world knowledge.

Skimming (Glancing for Gist)
Rapid eye-movement over headings, opening sentences, and summary paragraphs to extract the general overarching theme without getting stuck on unfamiliar words.

Scanning (Target Search)
Darting the eyes down a page to locate a specific, predetermined item of information (e.g., finding a train arrival time on a timetable, a phone number, or a historical date).

Coherence & Cohesion
Cohesion refers to visible grammatical and lexical connectors (however, therefore, this, they). **Coherence** is the underlying logical unity of ideas making a text sensible.

3.2 THE FOUR MAJOR TEXT GENRES IN SCHOOL DISCOURSES

1. Descriptive Texts
Paints a vivid sensory picture of a person, animal, historical monument, or landscape using sensory adjectives and spatial organizers.

Ex: "A Rainy Morning in Assam"

2. Narrative Texts
Chronicles a sequence of events across time featuring a setting, characters, central conflict, climax, and emotional resolution.

Ex: Folk tales, Biographies

3. Expository / Informative
Objective, factual explanation of scientific phenomena, historical eras, or processes using cause-and-effect and comparison.

Ex: "The Water Cycle" (Science)

4. Persuasive Texts
Aims to convince the reader to accept a specific viewpoint, adopt an attitude, or take action using rhetoric and evidence.

Ex: Advertisements, Debates

3.5 THE THREE-PHASE INSTRUCTIONAL READING MODEL

- 1. Pre-Reading (Schema Activation)**: Brainstorming time, predicting story outcomes from illustrations, pre-teaching 3–4 difficult bottleneck words.
- 2. While-Reading (Active Engagement)**: Silent reading with guiding prompt questions, confirming hypotheses, self-monitoring comprehension, annotating text.
- 3. Post-Reading (Integration & Reflection)**: Discussion, character analysis, debate, creative role-play, drawing emotional scenes, critical evaluation.

Good readers actively predict, clarify, and evaluate while reading!

3.6 KENNETH GOODMAN'S MISCUUE ANALYSIS

Linguist Kenneth Goodman revolutionized literacy by treating oral reading errors not as punishable mistakes, but as "Miscues"—diagnostic windows into the child's cognitive cueing systems:

- Graphophonic Miscue**: Reading "house" as "hourse" (child relies on visual letter shape, ignoring meaning).
- Syntactic Miscue**: Reading "The dog ran" as "The dog barked" (grammar fits, but visual word differs).
- Semantic Miscue**: Reading "The king sat on the pony" as "The king sat on the horse" (visual word differs, but meaning is 100% preserved!).

Never record semantic miscues; celebrate that the child is comprehending!

UNIT 4: VOCABULARY IN CONTEXT AND WORD ARCHITECTURE

Open vs. Closed Classes, Content vs. Function Words, Morphology & Lexical Relationships

WEIGHTAGE: 10 MARKS

4.1 & 4.2 A BASIC CLASSIFICATION OF WORDS: OPEN VS. CLOSED CLASSES & FUNCTION VS. CONTENT

Lexical Classification

A language's vocabulary is not a random list of words memorized from a dictionary; words operate in functional ecosystems. A mature teacher must understand the fundamental divide between open and closed classes:

KEY DIMENSION	OPEN-WORD CLASSES (CONTENT WORDS)	CLOSED-WORD CLASSES (FUNCTION WORDS)
Constituent Parts of Speech	Nouns, Lexical Main Verbs, Adjectives, Adverbs (e.g., teacher, sprint, beautiful, quietly).	Pronouns, Prepositions, Conjunctions, Determiners, Auxiliary Verbs (e.g., he, in, because, the, should).
Membership Flexibility	Infinite & Growing : New words are constantly invented and added (e.g., internet, selfie, vlog, download).	Finite & Static : Rarely accepts new coinages. The set of English pronouns or prepositions is closed.
Semantic Role	Carries primary semantic meaning and information of a sentence; heavy lexical payload.	Carries grammatical glue, signaling structural relationships between content words.
Stress in Spoken English	Typically stressed in natural connected speech.	Typically unstressed and pronounced in their weak forms (e.g., /tə/, /ən/).

4.4 MORPHOLOGICAL WORD FORMATION PROCESSES

Morphology & Affixation

1. Prefixation
Adding an affix to the front of a base/root word (usually alters meaning, keeps class):

un- + happy = unhappy
dis- + obey = disobey
re- + write = rewrite

2. Suffixation
Adding an affix to the end of a root (frequently transforms grammatical class):

teach (V) + -er = teacher (N)
beauty (N) + -ful = beautiful (Adj)
quick (Adj) + -ly = quickly (Adv)

3. Compounding
Joining two or more free root words to create a brand new single lexical item:

black + board = blackboard
tooth + paste = toothpaste
sun + flower = sunflower

4. Modifiers (Pre & Post)
Linguistic elements describing or restricting a head noun:

Pre: "A [eleven] girl"
Post: "The girl [with the red ribbon]"

Derivational vs. Inflectional Suffixes: Derivational suffixes create new words or change part of speech (e.g., care → careless). Inflectional suffixes only mark grammatical aspects without altering part of speech (e.g., play → plays, played, playing).

4.5 SEMANTIC LEXICAL RELATIONSHIPS & FIGURATIVE DISCOURSE

1. Synonyms & Antonyms
Synonyms: Words sharing near-identical core meanings (e.g., huge / gigantic, begin / commence). Note: True absolute synonyms are rare due to differing registers!
Antonyms: Binary lexical opposites (e.g., hot / cold, buy / sell, alive / dead).

2. Homophones vs. Homographs vs. Homonyms

- Homophones**: Same sound, different spelling & meaning (e.g., sun / son, sea / see, write / right).
- Homographs**: Same spelling, different sound & meaning (e.g., lead / li d/ (to guide) vs. lead /led/ (metal)).
- Homonyms**: Same sound AND same spelling, different meaning (e.g., bank (river edge) vs. bank (money)).

3. Phrasal Verbs, Idioms & Collocations

- Phrasal Verbs**: Verb + particle with non-literal meaning (e.g., give up, look after, turn down).
- Idioms**: Fixed cultural expressions whose overall meaning cannot be deduced from individual words (e.g., "a piece of cake", "break a leg").
- Collocations**: Natural habitual co-occurrence of words (e.g., fast food NOT quick food; make a mistake NOT do a mistake).

★ PAPER ST.5 PRACTICUM & INTERNAL ASSESSMENT ARCHITECTURE (15 MARKS)

Syllabus 2026

Practicum Tasks & Profile Portfolio 10 Marks LSRW Material Design + Reflective Journals	Institutional Unit Test 5 Marks Internal Written Evaluation
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Prescribed Practicum Requirements:

- Workshop Design Task**: Designing and preparing innovative, low-cost concrete teaching aids (TLMs) specifically engineered to develop Listening, Speaking, and Reading comprehension in elementary children.
- Word-Work Explorations**: Collecting text passages from Class 1 to 5 SCERT English textbooks; categorizing words into open vs. closed classes; designing minimal pair worksheets for pronunciation practice.
- Individual Trainee Portfolio**: Every trainee must maintain an organized individual profile and cumulative portfolio documenting all spoken dialogues, reading discourse reviews, and classroom theatre scripts across the semester.
- Reflective Journal**: Maintaining a daily reflective analytical journal capturing personal insights, vocabulary breakthroughs, and peer teaching feedback throughout the course.

School Internship (SIP-I) Linkage:

During SIP-I, student-teachers will observe children's spontaneous spoken English attempts, analyze reading errors through Kenneth Goodman's miscue analysis, create an active "Word Wall" inside the primary classroom, and submit a documented analytical report countersigned by the school head.